

Board invitation

One more build

Jan — you built the machine that became SA's largest bond originator, and then you built the organisation that speaks for the industry itself. Sold Direct is where we believe that industry goes next, and we would rather build it with your judgement in the room than read your critique of it afterwards. This is a board invitation — five percent, non-executive, one more build.

What Sold Direct is

A 0%-commission, WhatsApp-native way to sell property — launching in prime Cape Town, broadening into the upper market as the brand scales. Monetisation is legally clean and will look familiar: bond origination (via a multi-bank originator in Year 1, then in-house, direct with the banks, from Year 2 at ~1.5%), a 1% facilitation fee on cash deals, a bank headline sponsorship, and fixed conveyancer panel advertising — no referral fees, with the 30–40% panel discount passed to the consumer. Roughly R52–71k per deal without charging the seller a cent of commission. And it is positioned deliberately alongside the industry, not against it: we serve the segment that chooses to sell privately, we employ registered practitioners, and there is not one anti-agent line in our marketing (solddirect.co.za/compliance).

Why you — specifically

Our single biggest revenue line from Year 2 is taking origination in-house under our own bank aggregation agreements. You wrote the playbook for that industry. Beyond origination: your principal registration anchors our PPRA licensing from day one, your name signals to banks and investors that this is a serious operation, and your four decades of judgement keeps a young founding team honest. The structure is deliberately non-executive — board cadence, not client hours — and we know it has to sit carefully alongside your current commitments. We'll respect whatever shape that requires.

The numbers (base case, model-grade — CA-reviewed)

Revenue ramp	R6.1m (Y1) → R162.3m (Y5)
Profitability	EBITDA-positive Y3 · ~17% margin by Y5 (base), ~37% aggressive · 27% tax modelled — numbers built to survive diligence
Capital	Breakeven on ~R7.5m · R10m strategic funding secured against 20% · runway check: minimum cash position +R5.5m — the seed alone covers the trough
Valuation frame	R40m pre / R50m post at founding · Y5 EV R649–974m (4–6× revenue)

The offer

Equity	5% — board allocation, vesting over the service period. Working founders: Johannes 25% · Wilhelm 25% · Dean 25% · Strategic funder 20% (R10m)
Role	Non-executive director · registered principal for the firm's PPRA licence · origination and bank-relationship counsel
Upside	Base-case model: 5% is worth ~R34m at the ~R811m Year-5 exit (4.2% post-Series A)

Next step: an hour with the three of us — full data room, live model, and the WhatsApp journey demo. Bring the hard questions; the model was built to be interrogated, and we'd value nothing more than your red pen.